Community Sentiment on Shotspotter

Stop ShotSpotter Coalition
Camberville

The Reality of Shotspotter in Cambridge

Unauthorized Surveillance Without Community Knowledge or Consent

24/7 Always-On Surveillance

Not a passive acoustic system. Mircophones activetly listen, analyze, and record 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

Extreme Audio Range & Penetration

Captures normal-volume human conversations uo to 50 feet away, including audio penetrating from inside private building walls (Commonwealth v. Denison).

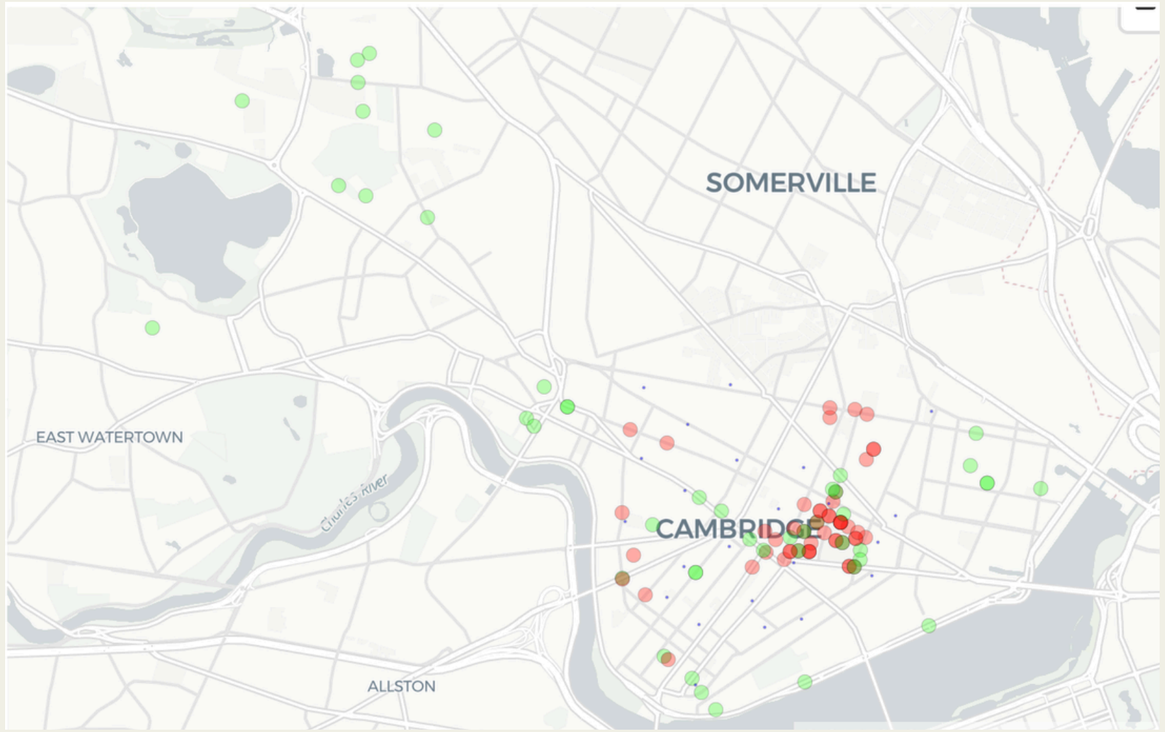
No Democratic Consent

A highly invasive surveillance network operating across Cambridge neighborhoods entirely without community consent, public hearings, or democratic oversight.



Source: The Boston Globe
Spencer Buell

Cambridge ShotSpotter Data Dashboard



Geographical Targeting: Mircophones are exclusively clustered in low-come and immigrant neighborhoods, mirroring historical redlining maps while leaving wealthier areas completely unmontiored.

82% **False Positive Rate**

The vast majority of alerts do not correspond to actual gunfire, dangerously misdirecting police resources and increasing unnecessary armed interactions in targeted area.

90% **Community Rejection**

Recent community survey reveals profound opposition. 9 out of 10 respondent cite deep concerns over privacy violations, racial profiling, and ICE collaboration.

Cambridge residents show deep uncertainty regarding Shotspotter, citing significant privacy and racial equity concerns.

Respondent Profile (N = 10)



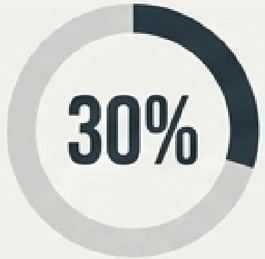
60% Black or African American



60% Afforable Housing Residents

An online survey questionnaire was used. Although the sample size is small, respondents represent deeply specific and highly impacted voices within Cambridge, particularly from neighborhoods such as The Port and East Cambridge.

Perception of the Problem



Only 30% view gun violence as a serious problem in their neighborhood. The majority see it as a minor issue or not a problem at all.

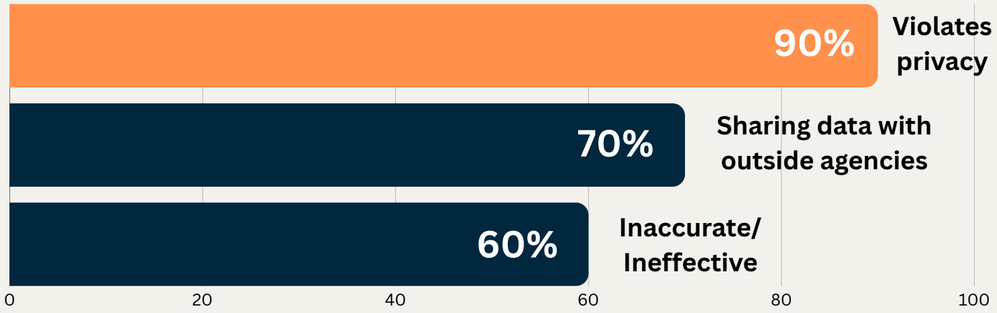
High Uncertainty on the Solution

70% UNSURE

When asked if they support the continued use of ShotSpotter in Cambridge, 70% were entirely unsure. Additionally, 60% are unconvinced it is a helpful tool.

Core Concerns: Privacy & Profiling

Top three system concerns



Voices of the Community

"It would be [helpful] if they were spread out across the city and not just in neighborhoods of color... Racial profiling."

"No because they are putting it in places of color... it's profiling!"

"If it's not used in every neighborhood, it's biased."

Community Perspectivies on ShotSpotter: Physical Survey Data from Cambridge Residents

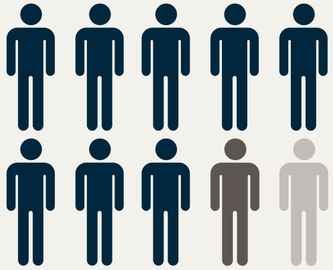
The Voices

14 to 70 Years of Residency in Cambridge

Homeowners, Renters, and Subsidized Senior/Disabled Housing Residents

Sample of 9 participants. Ages ranging from 23 to 73 & Aprox. 63% identifies as Black or African American

Percieved Local Threat



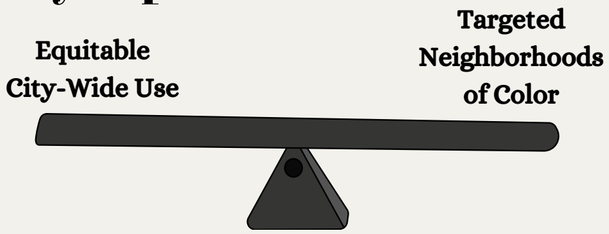
The vast majority report that gun violence is “not a problem,” “isn’t at all” or is “very little” in their specific neighborhoods.

Technical Trust

Deep skepticism regarding the operational parameters of the system.

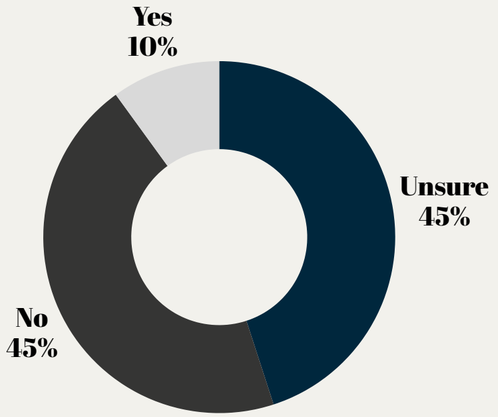
- Strict mitigation of “accuracy and false alerts” required
- Must detect shots “as specifically as possible”

The Equity Gap



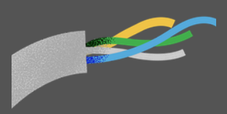
A dominant recurring theme is the fear of basis. Residents demand the technology be placed equitably throughout the city rather than concenctrated, which sparks fears of “racial profiling.”

The Verdict on Deployment



“Not without a conversation with all residents.”

The Path Forward



Terminate Infrastructure

Immediately end Cambridge's participation in the ShotSpotter program and physically remove all always listening microphones from neighborhoods.



Restore Democracy

Mandate a full City Council vote and public review process for the acquisition of any future surveillance technology, closing the federal grant loophole.



Invest in Community

Reallocate resources toward community-led, evidence-based apporaches to public safety rather thn unproven, unaccountable surveillance systems.

THANK YOU

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